

4.3 Unit content

What students need to learn:

Sections A and B

Students will need to explore the chosen play from the viewpoint of a director working with a company preparing the script for performance.

Students' understanding of the role of a director is essential to the response to both questions in this section.

Preparation for this section could include:

- exploring the social, cultural and historical context surrounding the writing and performing of the play and its relevance to students themselves and a contemporary audience
- practical exploration of the ways in which the playwright has structured the play and uses plot, language, forms, characterisation and stagecraft to communicate ideas to an audience
- demonstration of an understanding of production methods used to communicate the directorial concept and interpretation to an audience
- exploration of rehearsal methods/techniques used in practical workshop activities on and around the text
- students' understanding of the contribution made to rehearsal and performance by actors and designers
- opportunities to explore the ideas that will shape an original production interpretation of the play as a whole
- planning and structuring rehearsals based on characterisation
- planning and structuring rehearsals based on exploration of meaning
- planning and structuring of rehearsals based on recognised design elements
- preparing a director's copy of the chosen text to support students' written responses in this section.